

CRM Lifecycle & Workflow Specification (MVP)

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1. Executive Summary

The current CRM prototype already contains the main structural elements needed for the MVP:

- Lifecycle
- Status
- Processing
- Timeline
- Lead assignment
- Appointments
- Follow-ups
- Dashboards and reporting

The existing architecture remains:

```
Lifecycle
↓
Status
↓
Processing
```

The main changes are:

- Keep the current three-level structure.
- Use `Status` only for the broad sales phase.
- Use `Processing` for the current condition within that phase.
- Add `Next Action` as a separate operational field for what the consultant must do next.
- Store counters, dates and reasons as separate properties.
- Keep calls, messages, appointments and changes in the existing Timeline.
- Redefine `Qualified`.
- Define `Follow Up` narrowly as a deliberate pause until a later date, not every repeated task.
- Replace `Difficult Case` with a clear negative outcome and reason.
- Remove `Process completed` as a processing value.

2. CRM Architecture

The CRM should distinguish between the person, their relationship with Vion, the current sales phase, the operational processing state, the next required task and the historical activity log.

```
Person
↓
Lifecycle
↓
Status
↓
Processing
↓
Primary Task / Next Action
↓
Timeline
```

Object	Purpose	Example
Person	Central master record for an individual	Name, phone, email, ...
Lifecycle	Relationship of the person to Vion	Lead, Customer, Partner
Status	Broad sales phase	In Contact, Appointment, Follow Up
Processing	Current state inside the phase	Attempting Contact, Connected, No Show
Primary Task / Next Action	What the consultant must do next	Call again tomorrow
Timeline	Historical activities and changes	Call attempt, appointment completed
Properties	Structured data used for logic and reporting	Call Attempts, Lost Reason, Follow-Up Date
Outcome	Final business result	Customer, Partner, Lost

Business Object Principle

A **Person** is the central record. Lead, Customer and Partner should not create unrelated duplicate people. They describe relationships or lifecycle roles connected to the same person.

A person may therefore be:

- Lead only
- Customer only
- Partner only
- Customer + Partner

The unresolved distinction between a campaign-generated Lead and a consultant's personal network should be handled through source, ownership and system views rather than by duplicating the person record.

System-Driven Workflow Principle

The workflow should not require the consultant to manually interpret every status transition.

Recommended logic:

```
Consultant records an outcome
↓
System maps the result to Status and Processing
↓
System creates, updates or closes the Primary Task
↓
Timeline records the action and transition
```

The workflow remains flexible for consultants, while the resulting status model stays consistent for reporting.

3. Meaning of the Existing Levels

Lifecycle

Defines the person's relationship with Vion.

Recommended values:

- Lead
- Customer
- Partner

A person may later be both Customer and Partner.

Status

Defines the broad position of the lead in the sales process.

Examples:

- New
- In Contact
- Appointment
- Follow Up
- Qualified
- Closed
- Not Interested
- Not Reached
- Do Not Contact

Processing

Defines the current condition or next operational state inside the Status.

Examples:

- Not Contacted Yet
- Attempting Contact
- Connected
- Appointment Scheduled
- Appointment Completed
- Waiting for Follow-Up
- Ready to Close

Next Action

Defines what the consultant must do next without changing the Status.

Examples:

- Call again tomorrow
- Send information
- Schedule appointment
- Call to reschedule
- Review appointment outcome
- No open action

Every open lead should normally have either a Next Action with a due date or a scheduled appointment.

Properties

Store structured values that should not be encoded in Processing.

Examples:

- Call Attempts = 3
- Next Action
- Next Action Due Date
- Follow-Up Date
- Appointment Date
- Lost Reason
- Outcome

Timeline

Stores all activities and changes.

Examples:

- Call attempt
- Call connected
- SMS sent
- Appointment scheduled
- Appointment completed
- Status changed

4. Review of the Current Developer Mapping

Current Developer Mapping	Recommendation	Action	Reason
New / Not contacted yet	Keep	Keep	Clear initial state
In Contact / Initial message sent	Rename to First Contact Attempted	Modify	The first action may be a call, SMS or message
In Contact / Not reached after 1–4 attempts	Replace with Attempting Contact	Modify	Number of attempts belongs in Call Attempts property
In Contact / Reached after 1–5 attempts	Replace with Connected	Modify	Reached state and attempt counter should be separated
Not Reached / Not reached after 5 attempts	Keep Status, simplify Processing	Modify	Use Status Not Reached ; store attempt count separately
Not Interested during call	Keep Status, add Lost Reason	Modify	Channel belongs in Timeline, reason belongs in property
Not Interested during appointment	Keep Status, add Lost Reason	Modify	Same final status; appointment context is already documented
Currently Not Interested	Replace with Follow Up	Modify	“Maybe later” is a future follow-up, not a rejection
Difficult Case during call	Replace with Closed / Lost • reason	Remove / Replace	“Difficult” is too vague and not reportable
Difficult Case during appointment	Replace with Closed / Lost • reason	Remove / Replace	Same reason as above
Appointment / Appointment Scheduled	Keep	Keep	Appointment is a useful stage in Vion's process
Qualified / Appointment completed	Redefine	Modify	Appointment attendance does not equal qualification
Any final status / Process completed	Remove	Remove	Final status already indicates that the process is completed
Network / Customer	Keep	Keep	Valid lifecycle outcome
Network / Partner	Keep	Keep	Valid lifecycle outcome
Network / Prospect	Review separately	Review	May overlap with Lead and should be clarified later

5. Proposed Compact Mapping

Recommended MVP Mapping

No.	Lifecycle	Status	Processing	Main Trigger / Meaning
1	Lead	New	Not Contacted Yet	Lead created, not yet processed
2	Lead	In Contact	First Contact Attempted	First manual outreach recorded
3	Lead	In Contact	Attempting Contact	One or more attempts, no conversation yet
4	Lead	In Contact	Connected	Actual two-way contact took place
5	Lead	Appointment	Appointment Scheduled	Meeting or event appointment confirmed
6	Lead	Appointment	Appointment Completed	Appointment took place; outcome still pending
7	Lead	Follow Up	Waiting for Follow-Up	Lead may be interested later; date required
8	Lead	Qualified	Ready to Close	Concrete interest and realistic path to conversion
9	Lead	Closed	Customer	Product purchased or agreement signed
10	Lead	Closed	Partner	New business partner confirmed
11	Lead	Closed	Customer + Partner	Both outcomes apply
12	Lead	Not Interested	Closed	Clear permanent rejection
13	Lead	Not Reached	Closed	Maximum attempts reached without contact
14	Lead	Closed	Lost	Lead reached, but no suitable solution is possible
15	Lead	Do Not Contact	Closed	Legal, GDPR, invalid or blocked contact

6. Definitions of the Critical Values

In Contact

In Contact is the broad phase once active outreach has started.

The distinction is made through Processing:

- Attempting Contact** = not yet reached

- **Connected** = actual conversation took place

Example:

Status	Processing	Call Attempts	Meaning
---	---	---	---
In Contact	Attempting Contact	3	Called three times, never reached
In Contact	Connected	3	Reached on the third attempt

This preserves the current developer architecture while clearly distinguishing the two situations.

Appointment

Appointment remains a separate Status because appointments and events are central steps in the Vion sales process.

Processing values:

- Appointment Scheduled
- Appointment Completed

Additional appointment details should remain separate properties:

- Appointment Date
- Appointment Type
- Appointment Status

Recommended Appointment Status values:

- Scheduled
- Confirmed
- Rescheduled
- Cancelled
- No Show
- Completed

Qualified

A lead is **not** Qualified simply because an appointment was completed.

Recommended definition:

The lead has concrete interest and a realistic path toward becoming a customer or business partner.

Examples:

- Wants a concrete product proposal
- Agrees to provide financing documents

- Wants to start partner onboarding
- Is prepared to sign after final clarification

Follow Up

Use Follow Up only when the active sales process is deliberately paused until a clearly later date.

Examples:

- "Contact me again in three months."
- "The timing is currently not right."
- "I may be interested later."
- Follow up after a future event, document or personal milestone

Do **not** use Follow Up merely because another operational task is needed within the next few days.

Examples that remain in the current Status:

Situation	Status	Processing	Next Action
Two calls, lead not reached	In Contact	Attempting Contact	Call again tomorrow
Lead reached, appointment not yet fixed	In Contact	Connected	Schedule appointment
Lead missed appointment	Appointment	No Show	Call to reschedule
Appointment completed, outcome not recorded	Appointment	Appointment Completed	Record appointment result

Required Follow-Up properties:

- Follow-Up Date
- Follow-Up Reason
- Next Action = Resume follow-up
- Next Action Due Date = Follow-Up Date

Decision Rule

```

Further action within days and the active process continues
→ Keep current Status
→ Update Next Action

Deliberate pause for weeks or months
→ Status = Follow Up
→ Follow-Up Date required

```

Not Interested

Use when the lead clearly rejects the offer and no future sales follow-up is intended.

Examples:

- No interest
- Already has a suitable solution
- Does not want further consultation

Lost / No Suitable Solution

This replaces **Difficult Case**.

Use when the lead was reached and may have interest, but Vion cannot offer a suitable solution.

Examples:

- Credit not possible
- Financing requirements not met
- No suitable product
- Financial situation does not allow a solution
- Wrong target group

Recommended structure:

Status: Closed
Processing: Lost
Lost Reason: Credit not possible

This is much more useful for reporting than **Difficult Case**.

7. Required New Properties

Property	Type	Purpose
Call Attempts	Number	Number of unsuccessful or total contact attempts
Next Action	Select / Task Type	Concrete next step for the responsible consultant
Next Action Due Date	Date / Time	When the next operational action is due
First Connected Date	Date / Time	First successful conversation
Last Contact Date	Date / Time	Last contact activity
Follow-Up Date	Date / Time	Required for Follow Up
Follow-Up Reason	Select	Why future contact is planned
Appointment Date	Date / Time	Scheduled appointment
Appointment Status	Select	Scheduled, Completed, Cancelled, etc.
Qualified Date	Date / Time	When lead became Qualified
Outcome	Select	Customer, Partner, Customer + Partner, Lost
Lost Reason	Select	Reason why no conversion was possible

Property	Type	Purpose
Closed Date	Date / Time	Date of final outcome
Do Not Contact Reason	Select	GDPR, invalid contact, blocked, etc.

8. Recommended Lost Reasons

- No Interest
- Existing Solution
- Credit Not Possible
- Financing Requirements Not Met
- No Suitable Product
- Financial Situation
- Wrong Target Group
- Competitor Selected
- No Response After Previous Contact
- Invalid Contact Details
- Other

9. Business Rules

Contact Attempts

```

IF call result = No Answer
THEN Call Attempts = Call Attempts + 1
AND Status = In Contact
AND Processing = Attempting Contact
AND Next Action = Call again
AND Next Action Due Date is required
AND create Timeline Activity

```

```

IF call is connected
THEN Status = In Contact
AND Processing = Connected
AND save First Connected Date if empty
AND create Timeline Activity

```

```

IF Call Attempts >= 5
AND no successful connection exists
THEN Status = Not Reached
AND Processing = Closed

```

Appointment

```
IF appointment is scheduled
THEN Status = Appointment
AND Processing = Appointment Scheduled
AND Next Action = Attend / conduct appointment
AND Next Action Due Date = Appointment Date
```

```
IF appointment is completed
THEN Processing = Appointment Completed
AND Next Action = Record appointment result
AND consultant must record one outcome:
- Follow Up
- Qualified
- Not Interested
- Closed / Lost
```

```
IF appointment result = No Show
THEN Status = Appointment
AND Processing = No Show
AND Next Action = Call to reschedule
AND Next Action Due Date is required
```

An appointment completion or No Show must not automatically set the lead to Follow Up or Qualified.

Follow Up

```
IF Status = Follow Up
THEN Follow-Up Date is required
AND Follow-Up Reason is required
AND Next Action = Resume follow-up
AND Next Action Due Date = Follow-Up Date
```

```
IF another action is required within the active process
THEN keep the current Status
AND update Next Action instead of changing Status to Follow Up
```

```
IF Follow-Up Date = Today
THEN create reminder / task
```

Conversion

```
IF agreement is signed or product is purchased
THEN Status = Closed
AND Processing = Customer
AND Lifecycle includes Customer
```

```

IF partner onboarding is confirmed
THEN Status = Closed
AND Processing = Partner
AND Lifecycle includes Partner

```

A Customer may later additionally become a Partner.

9.1 Task / Next Action Trigger Matrix

The existing developer wireframes already include a Task function. Therefore, **Next Action** should not be implemented as a separate technical entity. It should be the user-facing representation of the most important open Task for the lead.

```

Task = technical data model
Next Action = primary open Task shown to the consultant

```

Trigger Matrix

Event / Result	Resulting Status	Resulting Processing	Task required?	Suggested Task / Next Action	Due date logic
---	---	---	---	---	---
Lead assigned to consultant	New	Not Contacted Yet	Yes	First contact	According to SLA or immediately
Call not answered, attempt 1-4	In Contact	Attempting Contact	Yes	Call again	Option for Consultant to select date; suggested next working day
Call not answered, attempt 5	Not Reached	Closed	No	None	Close any open contact task
Lead reached, interested but no appointment yet	In Contact	Connected	Yes	Schedule appointment / Send information	Consultant selects date
Lead reached, no clear result yet	In Contact	Connected	Yes	Call again / Send information / Schedule appointment	Option for Consultant to select date
Appointment scheduled	Appointment	Appointment Scheduled	Automatically covered by appointment	Conduct appointment	Appointment date and time
Appointment rescheduled	Appointment	Appointment Scheduled	Automatically update existing	Conduct appointment	New appointment

			task		date
Appointment cancelled by lead	Appointment	Cancelled	Yes, unless process is closed	Contact lead / Reschedule	Consultant selects date
Lead does not attend appointment	Appointment	No Show	Yes	Call to reschedule	Same or next working day
Appointment completed	Appointment	Appointment Completed	Yes	Record appointment outcome	Same day
Concrete conversion interest confirmed	Qualified	Ready to Close	Yes	Define next closing step	Consultant selects date
Lead asks to be contacted weeks or months later	Follow Up	Waiting for Follow-Up	Automatically create	Resume follow-up	Follow-Up Date
Lead clearly rejects offer	Not Interested	Closed	No	None	Close all open lead tasks
No suitable solution is possible	Closed	Lost	No	None	Close all open lead tasks
Product purchased / agreement signed	Closed	Customer	No lead task	Optional customer onboarding	Separate customer process
Partner onboarding confirmed	Closed	Partner	No lead task	Optional partner onboarding	Separate partner process
Do Not Contact set	Do Not Contact	Closed	No	None	Cancel all open tasks

Automation Levels

Automatic

The system can set or update the Task without further consultant selection when the result is unambiguous:

- Lead assigned → First contact
- Appointment scheduled → Conduct appointment
- Appointment rescheduled → Update appointment task
- Follow Up → Resume follow-up on Follow-Up Date
- Final Status → Close or cancel all open lead tasks

Task mandatory, date selected automatically or by consultant

The required Task is clear, but the correct time depends on the situation:

- Not reached, attempt 1–4 → Call again
- No Show → Call to reschedule
- Appointment cancelled → Contact lead / Reschedule
- Qualified → Define next closing step

Consultant selects the next step

After an actual conversation, several valid paths may exist. The consultant should choose one option:

- Schedule appointment
- Send information
- Call again
- Follow up later
- Not interested
- No suitable solution

The selected option should update Status, Processing and the primary open Task together.

Task Rules

- An open lead should normally have one primary open Task or one future appointment.
- Several historical Tasks may exist, but only one Task should be marked as the primary Next Action.
- When a new primary Task is created, the previous primary Task must be completed, cancelled or replaced.
- An overdue Task changes the Task status to **Overdue**, but must not automatically change the lead Status.
- Final lead statuses automatically close or cancel all remaining open lead Tasks.

Open Developer Confirmation

Confirm whether the existing Task model already supports:

- Task type
- Due date and time
- Owner
- Completion status
- Lead relation
- Automatic creation

- Automatic completion or cancellation
- Primary Task / Next Action flag

If these fields already exist, the required change is mainly trigger logic and UI display rather than a new module.

10. Recommended Changes to the Existing CRM Table

Current prototype fields can mostly remain.

Current Column	Recommendation
Feedback & Processing	Keep, but show Processing + activity counters
Status	Keep as broad Status
Last Activity	Keep
Timeline	Keep
Calls / SMS counters	Keep
New field	Add Follow-Up / Next Action date where relevant

Example Display

Lead	Status	Feedback & Processing	Next Action	Last Activity
Sandra Richter	In Contact	Attempting Contact · 3 calls · 1 SMS	Call tomorrow	Today
Peter Hoffmann	In Contact	Connected · 2 calls	Schedule appointment	Yesterday
Felix Wagner	Not Reached	Closed · 5 calls	None	3 days ago
Claudia Becker	Follow Up	Waiting for Follow-Up	15 October 2026	5 days ago
Lars Dietrich	Appointment	Appointment Scheduled	20 July 2026	3 days ago

11. Timeline Activities to Keep or Add

- Lead Created
- Lead Assigned
- Call Attempt
- Call Connected
- Email Sent
- SMS Sent
- WhatsApp Sent
- Appointment Scheduled

- Appointment Rescheduled
 - Appointment Cancelled
 - Appointment No Show
 - Appointment Completed
 - Document Sent
 - Document Received
 - Comment Added
 - Reminder Created
 - Status Changed
 - Processing Changed
 - Outcome Recorded
-

12. Impact on the Existing Developer Plan

Keep

- Lifecycle / Status / Processing architecture
- Existing Timeline
- Lead assignment logic
- Appointment module
- Dashboard modules
- Role structure
- Last Activity
- Call and message counters

Modify

- Simplify contact-attempt processing values
- Replace `Reached after X attempts` with `Connected`
- Replace `Not reached after X attempts` with `Attempting Contact`
- Store attempt count as property
- Redefine Qualified
- Rework Follow Up
- Replace Difficult Case
- Remove Process Completed

Add

- Call Attempts property
- Follow-Up Date and Reason
- Appointment Status
- Outcome
- Lost Reason
- Do Not Contact Reason

Expected Development Impact

Area	Impact
Database	Low to medium: a small number of new fields
Backend logic	Medium: update transitions and counters
Frontend	Low: mainly labels, required fields and display logic
Timeline	Low: already planned
Reporting	Positive: significantly cleaner KPIs
Existing prototype	Mostly preserved

13. Developer Handover Summary

The recommendation is not to replace the current CRM concept.

The developers can retain:

```
Lifecycle
↓
Status
↓
Processing
```

The required adjustment is primarily semantic:

- Status = broad sales stage
- Processing = current condition within the stage
- Properties = counters, dates, reasons and outcomes
- Timeline = historical activities

The most important concrete changes are:

1. Keep **In Contact** , but distinguish **Attempting Contact** and **Connected** in Processing.
2. Store call attempts as a number, not as multiple processing values.
3. Keep **Appointment** , but do not automatically convert a completed appointment into **Qualified** .

4. Define **Qualified** as concrete, realistic conversion potential.
5. Use **Follow Up** for temporary or future interest with a required date.
6. Replace **Difficult Case** with **Closed / Lost** and a structured Lost Reason.
7. Remove **Process completed** because the final Status already documents completion.
8. Store Customer, Partner and Customer + Partner as clear outcomes.

This model remains compact for consultants, fits the existing CRM prototype and provides a cleaner basis for dashboards, reporting and later marketing automation.

14. State Transition Model

The following model defines the normal MVP paths. It is not intended to block valid exceptions, but it should prevent contradictory combinations.

```
New
└ assignment / first action
  In Contact
  │ Attempting Contact
  │ │ reached → Connected
  │ │ further attempt required → remain In Contact + new Task
  │ │ maximum attempts reached → Not Reached
  │
  └ Connected
    │ appointment agreed → Appointment
    │ later interest → Follow Up
    │ concrete conversion path → Qualified
    │ permanent rejection → Not Interested
    └ no suitable solution → Closed / Lost

Appointment
└ Scheduled / Confirmed
└ Rescheduled → remain Appointment
└ No Show → remain Appointment + Call to reschedule Task
└ Completed
  │ later interest → Follow Up
  │ concrete conversion path → Qualified
  │ permanent rejection → Not Interested
  └ no suitable solution → Closed / Lost

Follow Up
└ date reached → return to In Contact, Appointment or Qualified
└ permanent rejection → Not Interested
└ no suitable solution → Closed / Lost

Qualified
└ product signed → Closed / Customer
└ partner confirmed → Closed / Partner
└ both outcomes → Closed / Customer + Partner
└ delayed decision → Follow Up
└ permanent rejection → Not Interested
└ no suitable solution → Closed / Lost
```

Allowed Return Transitions

A lead may move backwards when the commercial situation changes.

Examples:

- Appointment No Show → remains Appointment, not Follow Up
- Follow-Up Date reached → In Contact
- Qualified but decision delayed → Follow Up
- Follow Up becomes active again → In Contact or Appointment

Terminal Statuses

The following statuses end the active lead workflow:

- Closed / Customer
- Closed / Partner
- Closed / Customer + Partner
- Closed / Lost
- Not Interested
- Not Reached
- Do Not Contact

Terminal statuses must:

- close or cancel all open lead Tasks,
- save a Closed Date,
- store an Outcome or Reason where applicable,
- remain visible in Timeline and reporting.

Reopening

Reopening should be an explicit action, not an automatic side effect.

Recommended rule:

```
IF a final lead is reopened
THEN create Timeline entry
AND assign a new Status and Processing
AND create a new Primary Task
AND preserve the previous Outcome and closure history
```

15. Developer Glossary

Term	Definition	Must not be confused with
Person	Central individual record containing master data	Lead or Contact as separate duplicate people

Term	Definition	Must not be confused with
Contact	General person or network relationship visible in the CRM	A specific sales-process status
Lead	A person entering a trackable sales workflow, usually through a campaign or assignment	Every person stored in the CRM
Lifecycle	Relationship category between the person and Vion	Current sales phase
Status	Broad current phase of the lead workflow	Individual activity or counter
Processing	Current operational state within a Status	Historical Timeline event
Task	Technical object containing type, owner, due date and completion state	Status
Next Action	User-facing primary open Task for the lead	Follow Up status
Follow Up	Deliberate pause until a later date	Any short-term repeat call or task
Appointment	Sales phase in which a meeting or event is scheduled or evaluated	A completed qualification
Qualified	Concrete interest and realistic path to conversion	Appointment completed
Outcome	Final business result	Processing state
Lost Reason	Structured reason why no solution or conversion was possible	Generic Difficult Case
Timeline	Immutable or auditable sequence of activities and changes	Current state
Call Attempts	Numeric property counting attempts	Separate Processing values for every attempt number
Primary Task	Most important open Task displayed as Next Action	All historical Tasks
Company Lead	Lead generated or owned by Vion and assigned through the hierarchy	Consultant's personally sourced contact
Personal Network	Consultant-owned relationship or personally sourced person	The global Contacts menu